

FAQs

Windows 2000 boot options

Q. I have a Celeron system with 128 MB RAM, a 40 GB hard disk and three operating systems—Windows 98, Linux and Windows 2000 Professional. When the system boots, the Linux Loader gives me the following options: linux, hda1, hda2. When I select hda1, I get the options: Windows 98, Windows 2000, Windows 2000, i.e., Windows 2000 appears twice. How can I remove one of them?

Anoop Abraham

Via e-mail

A. Initially, the Linux Loader (LiLo) controls the boot process and gives you the options to boot to Linux or another operating system. When you select hda1, the Windows Flexi Boot Loader takes over and gives you the boot options that are configured in the Windows 2000 setup. You can modify this by editing the boot.ini file in the root of the boot drive (C). The options will be listed one below the other. All you have to do is delete the extra entry and save the file.

OpenGL missing

Q. Whenever I try to play *Soldier of Fortune I or II*, I get an error message that reads 'GLW_StartOpenGL()—could not load OpenGL subsystem'. I use a SiS graphics card on a Pentium 4 1.60 GHz PC with Windows XP. Please help.

Atul

Via e-mail

A. SiS graphics cards do not have support for OpenGL, which is required for games like *Soldier of Fortune* to run. You will have to upgrade to a more high-end graphics card, such as one of the GeForce series. Refer to the Test Drive on Graphics Chips in the

August 2002 issue to pick the right card suited for your needs and budget.

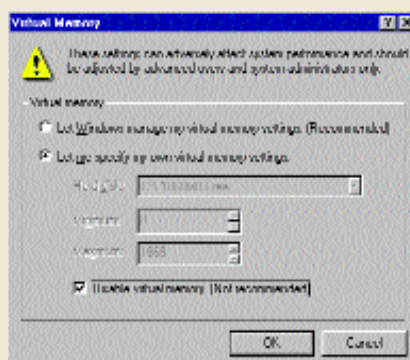
Scandisk repeats itself

Q. Scandisk and Disk Defragmenter never run completely on drive C of my PC. It keeps restarting, with a message that Windows or another program is writing to the drive. The C drive only contains the OS, Windows 98. I disabled Norton AntiVirus Auto-Protect. I cannot understand what program is running. How can I find and stop it?

Ajit Kanungoe

Via e-mail

A. The program that's running is Windows. You can't stop it, but you can prevent it from accessing the disk. Windows uses a swap file to temporarily store data when it runs



Disable Virtual Memory

out of RAM. It needs to constantly access this data, thus it is always accessing the drive. You can disable virtual memory from **Control Panel > System > Performance > Virtual Memory**. However, remember to enable it again after you finish running Scandisk and Disk Defragmenter, or you can expect a lot of blue screens and system crashes.

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Registry Checker

Q. I have a Pentium III 500 MHz PC running Windows 98 SE. Every time I start Windows, the Registry Checker runs, asking whether I would like to take a backup of the registry. On other PCs, the Registry Checker runs transparently, without prompting. How can I make my PC do that?

Swatilekha Doloi

Via e-mail

A. It is possible that someone has manually modified the settings for the Registry Checker on your PC.

To correct it, open the Registry Editor (click **Start > Run** and open regedit). Navigate to **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE \ Software \ Microsoft \ Windows \ CurrentVersion \ Run** and locate a string value named ScanRegistry. Its value should be **C:\Windows\scanregw.exe/autorun**. If it is not, modify it to this and the problem should be solved.

No more Windows

Q. I have Windows 95 installed. Is there any way to stop loading Windows without pressing [F8] at startup?

Vemuri Sreenivas

Via e-mail

A. Yes, there is a way to prevent the Windows GUI from loading automatically and make the system to boot to DOS instead. To do this, edit the **C:\msdos.sys** file and change the value of BootGUI to 0. When you want to load Windows, type **win** at the command prompt after it boots to DOS.

Send your computing problems to sos@jasubhai.com or write to Digit, D-222/2, Om Sagar, MIDC, Nerul-400 706, and we may answer it here!

happens when I try to download pictures from Webshots. I don't get this problem on other computers. I can download e-mail from Hotmail using Outlook Express.

Swati

Via e-mail

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